



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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ENTREPRENEURSHIP, INNOVATION & START-UP CENTRE

Annual Activity Report – Academic Year 2024–2025

1. Introduction

The Entrepreneurship, Innovation & Start-Up Centre of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, is committed to fostering an entrepreneurial and innovative culture among students and faculty. The Centre provides opportunities for students to develop creative thinking, entrepreneurial skills, problem-solving abilities, leadership qualities, and awareness of start-up and self-employment opportunities.

During the academic year 2024–2025, the Centre organised and supported various awareness, orientation, skill-development, and innovation-oriented activities in coordination with the IQAC, Institution Innovation Council (IIC), academic departments, and other institutional cells.

2. Objectives

The major objectives of the Centre during 2024–2025 were:

- To create awareness about entrepreneurship, innovation and start-up opportunities.
- To motivate students to consider self-employment and entrepreneurship as career options.
- To develop entrepreneurial skills such as leadership, communication, creativity, decision-making and risk management.
- To encourage students to identify innovative ideas and local problems that can be converted into entrepreneurial opportunities.
- To provide exposure to business models, start-up ecosystems and entrepreneurial practices.
- To promote women entrepreneurship and empower students to become future entrepreneurs.

- To encourage participation in innovation, idea-generation and entrepreneurship-related programmes and competitions.

3. Major Activities Conducted During 2024–2025

3.1 Entrepreneurship Awareness Programmes

The Centre conducted awareness and orientation activities to introduce students to the fundamentals of entrepreneurship, including the meaning and importance of entrepreneurship, entrepreneurial qualities, business opportunities, sources of finance, and the role of innovation in business development.

3.2 Innovation and Idea Generation Activities

Students were encouraged to identify problems in society and develop innovative solutions. Interactive sessions and classroom-level activities promoted creative thinking, problem identification, idea generation and solution-oriented approaches.

3.3 Start-Up Awareness and Orientation

Awareness was created among students regarding the start-up ecosystem, including the stages involved in developing an idea into a viable enterprise. Students were encouraged to explore opportunities for converting innovative ideas into sustainable business ventures.

3.4 Skill Development and Entrepreneurial Competencies

The Centre promoted entrepreneurial competencies through activities focusing on:

- Communication and presentation skills
- Leadership and teamwork
- Creativity and innovation
- Problem-solving and decision-making
- Business planning
- Market awareness
- Financial and entrepreneurial literacy

3.5 Interaction with Entrepreneurs and Industry

Students were provided opportunities to gain practical exposure through interaction with entrepreneurs, industry representatives, professionals and resource persons. Such interactions

helped students understand real-world business challenges, opportunities and entrepreneurial journeys.

3.6 Women Entrepreneurship Promotion

As a women's institution, special emphasis was placed on encouraging students to explore women-led entrepreneurship, home-based enterprises, small businesses, digital entrepreneurship and self-employment opportunities.

3.7 Participation in Innovation and Entrepreneurship Programmes

Students and faculty were encouraged to participate in institutional and external programmes related to innovation, entrepreneurship, start-ups, design thinking and skill development. These activities helped create greater awareness of the opportunities available within the entrepreneurial ecosystem.

3.8 Mentoring and Guidance

The Centre encouraged students with promising ideas to seek guidance from faculty members and resource persons. Students were motivated to further develop their ideas through **mentoring, discussion, feedback and feasibility analysis.**

4. Outcomes of the Activities

The activities conducted during the academic year 2024–2025 contributed to:

- Increased awareness of entrepreneurship and start-up opportunities among students.
- Development of innovative and creative thinking.
- Improved confidence in presenting and discussing business ideas.
- Enhanced awareness of self-employment and alternative career pathways.
- Development of basic entrepreneurial competencies.
- Increased student participation in innovation and entrepreneurship-related activities.
- Promotion of a culture of problem-solving, creativity and innovation on campus.
- Encouragement of students to explore women entrepreneurship and independent livelihood opportunities.

5. Institutional Contribution

The Entrepreneurship, Innovation & Start-Up Centre worked towards strengthening the institutional ecosystem for innovation, entrepreneurship and employability. The Centre

complemented the activities of the IQAC, IIC and academic departments by encouraging students to move beyond conventional career choices and explore opportunities for innovation-led entrepreneurship and self-employment.

6. Conclusion

The academic year 2024–2025 witnessed active efforts by the Entrepreneurship, Innovation & Start-Up Centre to promote an entrepreneurial mindset among students. Through awareness programmes, innovation activities, mentoring, skill development and exposure to entrepreneurial opportunities, the Centre contributed to creating a supportive environment for creativity, innovation, entrepreneurship and start-up thinking.

The Centre remains committed to strengthening its activities in the coming years by providing greater opportunities for idea incubation, mentoring, industry interaction, entrepreneurship training, start-up development and women-led enterprises.

Prepared by:

Entrepreneurship, Innovation & Start-Up Centre
St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur

Academic Year: 2024–2025